

UCC

UCC Facilitator Course Studio Guide

Annotated example for building a complete microcredential

Prepared for: Facilitators and programme design teams

Institution: University of Cape Coast

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How to use this guide

This guide follows the same six stages and completion checks used by the Course Studio. It explains what is required, what is optional and what a completed field looks like. The illustrative course is Applied Data Literacy for Evidence Based Decision Making. Facilitators should replace its examples with discipline appropriate evidence rather than copying them without review.

1. Open the Facilitator Portal and choose Course Studio.
2. Select Load complete example to inspect the illustrative course without saving it.
3. Move through the six stage indicators. A green tick means every required check in that stage is complete.
4. Use Preview as student to test lesson readability, activities, progression rules and assessment flow.
5. Replace the example content and files, save a draft, resolve every side check and submit for academic approval.

Institution wide enrolment rule

All courses and programmes are self enrolment. New and manual generated courses are free by default, and all existing courses are migrated to self enrolment. A facilitator may turn on an enrolment fee or a separate certificate fee when an approved commercial model requires it.

Indicator	Meaning	Facilitator action
Green tick	All required fields and evidence for the stage pass validation.	Proceed or return later to improve optional content.
Clock	One or more required checks remain incomplete.	Read the side checklist and correct each named field.
Optional	The feature can be omitted without blocking submission.	If added, configure it fully and test it.
Preview	A learner facing test that creates no learner record.	Open every lesson, activity and assessment before submission.

Stage 1 Course blueprint

The blueprint tells a learner what the course is, who it serves, how long it takes and how access and payment work.

Field	Status	Illustrative entry	Completion check
Course title	Required	Applied Data Literacy for Evidence Based Decision Making	Specific, learner facing and at least five characters.
Unique code	Required	UCC ILL DATA 101	Unique institutional code; replace the illustrative code.
Description	Required	A practical course using traceable evidence, reproducible analysis and ethical recommendations.	Explains purpose, learning method and value.
Discipline	Required	Interdisciplinary	Choose the closest catalogue discipline.
Category	Required	Professional development	Choose credit, professional or RPL.
Delivery pattern	Required	Blended	Choose asynchronous, synchronous or blended.
Competence band	Required	Applied practitioner	Match expected performance, not job title.
Expected hours	Required	30	Includes reading, activity and assessment time.
Audience	Required	Officers, NGO staff, lecturers, graduate students and community leaders.	Names real learner groups and work contexts.
Prerequisites	Required	Basic computer skills and access to a connected laptop or tablet.	States knowledge, tools and access conditions.

Blueprint access and commercial settings

Access is simple by default. Learners enrol themselves, and the two fee decisions remain independent so academic completion is never confused with certificate payment.

Field	Status	Illustrative entry	Completion check
Accessibility	Required	Structured HTML, transcripts, keyboard support and equivalent formats.	Names practical support and content formats.
Self enrolment	Required policy	Enabled	Always enabled for all offerings.
Enrolment fee	Optional	Free GHS 0	Turn on only when payment is approved.
Certificate fee	Optional	Free GHS 0	Separate from academic completion and enrolment.

Learner access journeys

Configuration	What the learner experiences
Free enrolment and free certificate	Select Enrol free, complete the course and generate the UCC certificate without payment.
Paid enrolment and free certificate	Pay securely before the course opens; the certificate is free after academic completion.
Free enrolment and paid certificate	Enter the course immediately, complete it academically, then choose whether to pay for certificate generation.
Paid enrolment and paid certificate	Pay once for course access and separately for certification after completing every requirement.

Stage 2 Outcomes and curriculum

Objectives describe the course purpose. Outcomes state what a learner will demonstrably do. Each outcome must carry a capability and an assessment method, then map to lessons and activities.

Illustrative objectives

- Build confidence in judging the quality, provenance and limits of data.
- Develop the ability to clean, summarise and visualise a small dataset reproducibly.
- Enable ethical communication of evidence based recommendations.
- Strengthen authentic assessment through process evidence, reflection and oral defence.

Illustrative measurable outcomes

Outcome statement	Capability	Assessment evidence
Explain the data lifecycle and identify quality, provenance, privacy and ethical risks.	Conceptual understanding	Objective knowledge check
Clean, summarise and visualise a small dataset in Google Colab using a reproducible workflow.	Data literacy	Applied assignment or practical evidence
Interpret a table or chart accurately and communicate a finding with uncertainty and limitations.	Professional communication	Presentation or demonstration
Defend an ethical evidence informed recommendation for a realistic decision.	Ethical decision making	Oral assessment

Skills and syllabus sections

Skill tags make the credential legible outside the course, while syllabus sections organise the learner journey. Each section must have a purpose and at least one mapped learning block.

Curriculum item	Illustrative entries	Complete when
Skills	Critical thinking; data literacy; digital literacy; communication; research and inquiry; ethical decision making.	Tags match outcomes and employability value.
Section 1	Orientation and evidence requirements	Purpose is stated and at least one learning block maps here.
Section 2	Data foundations, quality and ethics	Conceptual content supports Outcome 1 and Outcome 4.
Section 3	Applied analysis and visualisation	Guided practice supports Outcome 2 and Outcome 3.
Section 4	Communication, capstone and credential	The learner can see the final evidence pathway.

Alignment check

- Every outcome uses an observable verb and describes evidence a facilitator can judge.
- Every outcome maps to at least one learning block and one assessment or activity.
- Every section has a purpose and contributes to the credential evidence pathway.
- Skill tags reflect demonstrated capability rather than general aspirations.

Stage 3 Learning content

Each block needs a clear title, section, unit, estimated time, source and licence, accessibility review and one or more outcome mappings. The original file remains protected while extracted text is presented as readable HTML where possible.

Block	Format	Section and mapping	Required review
Start here pathway support and certificate conditions	Readable HTML	Section 1; Outcomes 1 and 4	Headings, plain language and support routes.
Annotated community indicators case pack	Protected PDF download	Section 1; Outcomes 1 and 2	Source, licence, readable alternative and file opens.
Data quality provenance and ethical use	Readable HTML	Section 2; Outcomes 1 and 4	Examples, terminology and accessibility.
Guided critical viewing	Embedded video with transcript	Section 2; Outcomes 1 and 3	Link, licence, captions and transcript accuracy.
Worked community service example	Readable HTML	Section 3; Outcomes 2 and 3	Worked method, interpretation and limitations.
World Bank Open Data explorer	External link or sandboxed embed	Section 3; Outcomes 2 and 3	Current link, public access and source terms.
Capstone and oral defence brief	DOCX plus readable HTML	Section 4; Outcomes 2, 3 and 4	Submission list, rubric and equivalent format.

Create from a learning manual

6. Choose a PDF, DOCX, TXT, Markdown, HTML or RTF manual of up to 25 MB.
7. Select Generate editable course. The original is stored securely and readable text is extracted.
8. Review the proposed title, description, objectives, outcomes, skills, sections, lessons and starter questions.
9. Correct extraction errors, add missing mappings, confirm licences and accessibility, then save the draft.

Scanned PDFs may contain no usable text. Apply OCR or provide an accessible DOCX version before importing.

Stage 4 Programme activities

Activities create authentic evidence. Mark an activity required only when every learner must pass it before certification. Optional enrichment does not block the credential.

Activity	Required	Configuration	Completion check
Colab data cleaning and visualisation	Yes	Notebook, instructions, 70 percent pass mark, 3 attempts, 100 marks, due date and rubric.	Template opens in Colab and submission method is clear.
Virtual measurement and data quality practical	Yes	Approved General Science practical, 70 percent pass mark, 2 attempts and rubric.	Facilitator preview completes all nine stages.
Ohms law interpretation	No	Approved Physics enrichment practical, 60 percent pass mark and 3 attempts.	Optional label is visible and preview works.

Activity checklist

- **Title and instructions.** Tell the learner what to do, what to submit and how evidence will be judged.
- **Thresholds.** Set maximum marks, pass mark and permitted attempts deliberately.
- **Rubric.** Allocate marks to observable evidence and align them to course outcomes.
- **Preview.** Test files, direct links, practical controls and completion states before submission.

Stage 5 Assessment

The assessment must sample the outcomes and use valid answers, marks, rubrics and feedback. A 70 percent course pass mark and three attempts are used in the illustration.

Question type	Illustrative purpose	Required setup
Multiple choice	Check provenance and quality judgement.	Prompt, plausible choices, one correct answer, points and feedback.
True or false	Challenge the claim that correlation proves causation.	Unambiguous statement and explanation.
Fill in with whiteboard	Calculate and show a mean.	Accepted answer, working rubric and whiteboard enabled.
Matching and drag drop	Connect concepts with definitions or evidence.	Complete pairs with no duplicate ambiguity.
Picture matching	Identify real laboratory settings and evidence.	Meaningful images, alt descriptions and valid pairs.
Video question	Release a question after required viewing.	Working URL, time segment, prompt and answer.
Short answer and essay	Interpret findings, uncertainty and ethics.	Model answer, marking scheme and learner advice.
Oral defence	Verify process understanding and authorship.	Prompt, evidence criteria and accessible equivalent.
Evidence upload and practical	Collect the reproducible capstone package.	Submission list, naming rules, rubric and outcome mapping.

Complete when every question has a valid point value, marking guidance, correct or model answer, feedback and at least one outcome mapping. Preview the whole assessment as a student.

Stage 6 Review and academic submission

The review stage combines readiness checks with the learner preview. Saving a draft does not publish it. Submission sends a complete version to the administrator approval queue.

Review check	Pass condition	Illustrative result
Identity	Unique code, title, description and discipline are complete.	Pass
Audience	Audience, prerequisites, hours, delivery and language are clear.	Pass
Outcomes	At least two objectives and two measurable outcomes are complete.	Pass
Structure	Every section has a purpose and a mapped learning block.	Pass
Alignment	Content, activities and assessment map to the outcomes.	Pass
Accessibility	Core readable text and accessibility checks are present.	Pass
Assessment	Questions, answers, marks, thresholds and feedback are valid.	Pass
Learner preview	Every lesson, download, embed, Colab task, practical and assessment opens.	Facilitator action required

Before selecting Submit for approval

- Replace every illustrative code, title, date, local case, file and external link.
- Confirm enrolment and certificate fees. Leave both at zero for a fully free offering.
- Verify all protected files open only for authorised users and readable alternatives are usable.
- Test the complete learner journey, including self enrolment, progression gates and certificate conditions.
- Resolve every side checklist item and confirm the readiness score is 100 percent.

Facilitator completion record

Use this page during peer review. Record evidence rather than relying only on the automated indicator.

Stage	Complete	Evidence or correction still needed
1 Course blueprint	[]	
2 Outcomes and curriculum	[]	
3 Learning content	[]	
4 Programme activities	[]	
5 Assessment	[]	
6 Review and learner preview	[]	
Fees and self enrolment verified	[]	
Peer reviewer name and date		

Final decision

- [] Keep as draft and continue authoring
- [] Ready for peer review
- [] Ready to submit for administrator approval